CODESCHOOL · SCHOOL INTERVIEWS 2026

Interview Field Kit

Everything to print, carry and fill on a school visit: letter, consent sheet, guides with note space, the Level B3 lesson, observation sheet and device audit.

Companion to the CodeSchool Research Pack

Interviews: 16 November - 11 December 2026

Fillable on screen or printable · use school codes (S01-S20), never names

Save filled copies outside the public repository

How to use this kit

Print what you need for each visit, or fill the fields on a laptop or tablet during the interview. Every page works on paper.

Print per school	Copies	Pages
Introduction letter (send before the visit)	1	1
Participant information and consent sheet	1 per person (up to 4)	1
Interview guide for each role you'll meet	1 per role	1-2 each
Level B3 teacher script + observation sheet	1 set	3
B3 student sheet (to show the teacher)	1-2	1
Device audit	1	2
Same-day debrief	1	1

Before you fill anything in

Privacy. Use school codes (S01-S20) and roles, never names. Do not interview, photograph or record students. Keep filled copies, audio and notes **outside the public GitHub repository** (for example in a private, backed-up folder); name digital copies `*.private.pdf`. Delete audio once notes are written.

What to carry

	Item
☐	Printed copies listed above, plus spares
☐	Pen, clipboard, sticky notes
☐	Phone charged, with audio recorder app (only used with consent)
☐	School code assigned in the private tracking sheet
☐	Name and role of each person you're meeting, and the appointment time
☐	Small thank-you (optional): a promise of the cross-school summary in January 2027

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1. Before the visit

A checklist for each school, from first contact to the day of the visit.

School code

Done	Step	Date / note
☐	Assign a school code and add the school to the private tracking sheet	
☐	Send the introduction letter (email or WhatsApp) to the principal or coordinator	
☐	Follow up after 3 working days if there is no reply	
☐	Agree dates and times for each role (principal, coordinator, Class 3-5 teacher, computer teacher)	
☐	Ask whether the school allows audio recording at all	
☐	Confirm the day before; ask for a quiet room for the teacher walkthrough	
☐	Print the kit pages for this school	
☐	Re-read the hypotheses (H1-H13) and the decision rule	

Ground rules (read before every interview)

- **Learn, don't sell.** No pitch until the last five minutes, and only if asked.
- **Ask about past behaviour, not hypotheticals.** "What did you buy last year?" beats "Would you buy…?"
- **Consent first.** Read the opening script; record audio only with a clear yes.
- **No children.** No student interviews, photos or recordings.
- **Quote, don't paraphrase.** Write exact words where you can, attributed by role.
- **Stay neutral.** Don't react to answers about price or CBSE; note the reaction instead.

2. Introduction letter

Fill the fields, then print, email or paste into WhatsApp. One page.

To (name and role)

School name

Your phone / WhatsApp

Your email

Dear Sir / Madam,

I'm **Anoop Dobhal**, and I'm researching how schools are teaching **Computational Thinking and AI** in Classes 3-8, including CBSE's new curriculum for 2026-27. Before building anything, I want to understand what schools and teachers actually need.

I'm requesting short conversations with up to four people at your school:

Who	Time
Principal or owner	30 minutes
Academic or CBSE coordinator	30-40 minutes
A Class 3-5 maths or EVS teacher	40 minutes, including feedback on one printed sample lesson
Computer teacher (if the school has one)	30 minutes

These can be in person at a time that suits you, or by phone or video call, between **16 November and 11 December 2026**.

What I'll ask about: how CT&AI and computer classes are going this year, what teachers find hard, what equipment is available, and how the school chooses academic resources.

What this isn't: a sales visit. I'm not selling anything, and there's no product to buy yet.

Your privacy: your school and staff won't be named in anything I share. I'll take notes and record audio only if the person agrees. I won't talk to, photograph or record any students. You can skip any question or stop at any time.

What you get: a free summary of what I learn from 15-20 schools about how others are handling CT&AI, sent to you in January 2027.

Thank you for considering this. Please reply to this message or contact me using the phone number and email above.

Warm regards,
Anoop Dobhal
CodeSchool

3. Participant information and consent

Give one copy to each person. Read the opening script aloud before the first question.

Opening script (read aloud)

"Thank you for your time. I'm researching how schools teach computational thinking and AI, so that anything we build later actually helps teachers and students. This isn't a sales call. I'll take notes. Is it all right if I also record the audio, just for my own notes? It won't be shared. Your name and the school's name won't appear in anything I share. You can skip any question or stop at any time. Do you have any questions before we start?"

Information for participants

Who is asking	Anoop Dobhal, founder of CodeSchool, an early-stage education project. Contact details are in the introduction letter.
Why	To understand how schools teach computational thinking and AI in Classes 3-8, before any product is built.
What you'll do	Answer questions for 15-40 minutes. Teachers may also look at a printed sample lesson and give feedback.
Voluntary	You can decline, skip any question or stop at any time, without giving a reason.
What is recorded	Written notes. Audio only if you agree, used only to check notes and deleted afterwards.
How it is kept	Notes use a school code and your role, not names. They are stored privately, not in any public place, and are not shared with your employer or anyone else.
How it is used	Findings are combined across 15-20 schools. No school or person is named. You'll receive the summary in January 2027.
Students	No student is interviewed, photographed or recorded.

Consent record (filled by the interviewer)

Person (role only)	Agrees to take part	Agrees to notes	Agrees to audio	Date
	-	-	-	
	-	-	-	
	-	-	-	
	-	-	-	

Consent is verbal and recorded here by the interviewer; no signature is needed. Get legal advice on India's DPDP Act before any pilot that involves student data (out of scope for interviews).

4. Interview guides with note space

One guide per role. Type into the boxes or print and write. Questions in bold test the newest risks.

4.1 Principal or owner (30 min)

School code		Date		Role		Start-end	

☐ Consent to notes ☐ Consent to audio ☐ Info sheet given ☐ No student data recorded

1. Tell me about the school: board, number of students, classes covered, fees roughly.

2. Who decides which books and digital products the school buys, and when? **Who signs the book list that goes on your website, and does a fee committee review it?**

3. How are you handling CBSE's Computational Thinking and AI curriculum this year? (ICSE: how do you teach computers in Classes 1-8?)

4. **Which Computers and CT&AI books are on your 2026-27 book list, from which publisher, and at what price? Did you consider Oxford, Goyal or Uolo's Tekie? Do you use any platform?**

5. What's working, and what isn't?

6. Walk me through the last time you bought a new academic product. Who was involved, and how long did it take?

7. When do your book and resource lists close for the next session? **How do publishers usually work with you: specimen copies, training, terms? By when must specimens reach you?** (Ask neutrally; don't ask about commissions.)

8. **Which fee heads do you charge, such as computer, smart class or activity? Would a new product go on the book list, come out of an existing fee, or come out of the school budget? Has a fee committee or parent body ever questioned a charge?**

9. **Do parents buy books from the school, a named shop, or anywhere they like?**

10. **Price anchors (packages):** "Products like this come as a Rs 300 school licence plus GST, a Rs 450-600 workbook with app access on the book list, or an Rs 800 book-plus-platform with training. Which would be easy, hard or impossible for your school?" Then: **"Would it replace your current computer book or sit alongside it?"**

11. If you could fix one thing about how computing or CT&AI is taught here, what would it be?

12. Who else here should I talk to? Would you be open to a free pilot in one or two sections next session?

Price-anchor reaction	Rs 300 licence	-	Rs 450-600 pack	-	Rs 800 platform	-
Would it replace the current Computers book?	-		**Route**	-		
Best quote from this interview						

4.2 CBSE / academic coordinator (30-40 min)

School code		Date		Role		Start-end	

☐ Consent to notes ☐ Consent to audio ☐ Info sheet given ☐ No student data recorded

1. Has the school timetabled CT&AI for Classes 3-8 this year? Which classes, and how many periods a week?

2. Who teaches it in Classes 3-5? In Classes 6-8?

3. Are you using the free CBSE CT&AI student and teacher books? How are teachers finding them?

4. Did teachers attend any CBSE training for CT&AI this year (district or regional workshops, a lead-school session, DD PM e-Vidya videos)? Was it useful?

5. How is CT&AI being assessed? **CBSE hasn't published marks weightage or a report-card format. What will appear on this year's report card?**

6. What do parents ask about it?

7. What would make it easier to deliver: lesson plans, worksheets, a platform, training, assessment tools?

8. **Classes 6-8 have 40 hours of projects and the books have no project materials. What are students doing? Who designs and marks them? Has CBSE's promised project list with rubrics reached the school?**

9. **CBSE's webinar says the curriculum needs "no coding/software". Does the school plan to teach Scratch or any coding in Classes 3-8 anyway? Why or why not?**

10. How are teachers keeping the Teacher Observation Journal? Do you have a format for it?

11. Have any vendors approached you about CT&AI, **such as Oxford, Goyal, Uolo Tekie, STEMpedia, LEAD, Thinking Juggernaut, PiyushAI or Scaleopal?** What did they offer, and at what price?

12. **When an app needs student logins, who creates them and what details does the school share? Does the school take parent consent for apps? Has anyone raised the DPDP Act (India's data-protection law)?**

13. (ICSE only) Have you heard anything from CISCE about CT or AI for the younger classes?

Best quote from this interview

4.3 Class 3-5 maths or EVS teacher (40 min)

School code		Date		Role		Start-end	

☐ Consent to notes ☐ Consent to audio ☐ Info sheet given ☐ No student data recorded

1. How long have you been teaching, and which subjects?

2. Have you taught any CT&AI lessons yet? Tell me about the last one.

3. What was hardest to prepare or explain? Are the handbook puzzles too easy, about right, or too hard for your students?

4. Have you tried the handbook activities (Caesar cipher in Class 3, Coin Flip Magic or the Sorting Network in Class 4, the weighing-scale search in Class 5)? How did they go?

5. How much time do you have to plan a new lesson in a typical week?

6. Have you used any computer or tablet activities with your class? What happened?

7. **Paper prototype (20 min):** walk through the Level B3 lesson using the observation sheet. Then: could you run this in one period tomorrow? What would stop you?

8. What would make you look forward to teaching this, instead of seeing it as extra work?

Best quote from this interview

4.4 Computer teacher (30 min)

School code		Date		Role		Start-end	

☐ Consent to notes ☐ Consent to audio ☐ Info sheet given ☐ No student data recorded

1. **Device audit:** complete the device audit with numbers, not impressions.

2. What do you teach in Classes 3-8 today, and with which tools (Scratch, PictoBlox, Python, MS Office)?

3. CBSE gives computer teachers the AI-literacy part of CT&AI in Classes 6-8 and has them assess the projects. Are you doing that this year? With which tools, and how is it going?

4. **The Class 8 book has three Teachable Machine labs (waste classifier, voice commands, cat/dog bias). Has anyone run them? Do you have the webcams, microphones and internet they need?**

5. When do students first write Python or another text language? CBSE has none before Class 11. How do students cope with Class 11 Python?

6. What do students find hardest when they move from blocks to typing code?

7. **How do students log in to any platform today: roll number, school email, or a parent's phone?**

Best quote from this interview

4.5 Parents (optional, 15 min, through the school)

School code		Date		Role		Start-end	

☐ Consent to notes ☐ Consent to audio ☐ Info sheet given ☐ No student data recorded

1. What does your child do in computer or CT&AI class? How do you know?

2. What do you want them to learn about computers and AI over the next few years?

3. Have you ever paid for coding classes or apps outside school? Why did you stop or continue?

4. If the school's program had a home practice part, how much would you pay a month, if anything?

5. What would make you trust an education app? **Would you be comfortable with the school giving an app your child's class and roll number? Do you use DigiLocker?**

6. **Where did you buy this year's books: the school, a named shop, or anywhere?**

Best quote from this interview

5. Level B3: Robo makes choices

A test lesson for teacher interviews, not a finished product. Pages 5.1-5.2 are for the teacher, 5.3 for the interviewer, 5.4 for students.

Band / level	B (Builders, Classes 3-5) · Level B3: conditionals
Written for	Class 4 (works for Classes 3-5) · one 40-minute period
Devices	None needed. Optional: projector for the code cards
Structure	PRIMM + Parsons: Predict & Run → Investigate → Modify → Parsons puzzle → Make
Learning goal	Students explain that an **if-else** block makes the program choose between two actions, checked every time the loop repeats
Builds on	B1 (sequence and loops), B2 (events)
Curriculum link	Class 3 skip rule (*Filling and Lifting*); Class 4 *Hide and Seek* and *The Cleanest Village* ("the puzzle in your book, now you build it"). Explicit if-then is a CBSE Class 7 outcome, so if-else at Class 4 is a deliberate stretch the interviews test

Before class (5 minutes): draw a row of 5 squares on the floor or board (chalk or tape); print one student sheet per pair; cut out the Parsons blocks or let students cut them.

5.1 Teacher script: steps 1-2

Step 1. Predict and run (8 minutes)

```
   1          2          3          4          5
[ START ]  [ PUDDLE ]  [ plain ]  [ PUDDLE ]  [ plain ]
  Robo >
```

Show code card A (write it on the board or project it):

```
when green flag clicked
repeat 4 times
    move forward 1 square
    if < on a puddle? > then
        say [Splash!]
    else
        say [Step]
    end
end
```

Say: "This is Robo. Robo is on the START square, facing right. Read the program with your partner. **Before we run it**, write down everything Robo will say, in order." Give 2 minutes. Take 2-3 guesses and write them on the board without saying which is right.

Run it: one student acts as Robo on the floor grid. The class reads the program aloud, one block at a time. Robo moves and speaks.

Answer: Robo says **Splash! · Step · Splash! · Step** and ends on square 5. **Ask:** "Who predicted correctly? If you didn't, where did your guess go wrong?"

Step 2. Investigate (8 minutes)

Ask one at a time. Pairs discuss for 30 seconds, then share.

#	Question	Answer	What to listen for
1	How many times did Robo say "Splash!"? Why?	2, because Robo was on a puddle twice	Linking the output to the squares
2	Which block makes Robo **choose** what to say?	The **if-else** block	Pointing to the right block, not "repeat"
3	If every square were plain, what would Robo say?	Step, Step, Step, Step	**Else** runs when the condition is false

#	Question	Answer	What to listen for
4	If the **if-else** came *after* the repeat (outside it), how many times would Robo check for a puddle?	Once, only on square 5, so "Step" once	**Hardest:** the check happens every time only because it's inside the loop

- **Misconception:** "Robo says Splash and Step every time." Point to **if… then… else**: only one happens each time.
- **Misconception:** "The if checks once at the start." Act it out again and pause at each square: "Robo, are you on a puddle **now**?"

5.2 Teacher script: steps 3-5

Step 3. Modify (8 minutes)

```
   1         2         3         4         5
[ START ]  [ plain ]  [ STAR ]  [ STAR ]  [ plain ]
  Robo >
```

Say: "Change code card A so that Robo says **'Star!'** on a star square and **'Step'** on any other square. Change only the **if-else** block."

Answer: change `< on a puddle? >` to `< on a star? >` and `[Splash!]` to `[Star!]`. **Output:** Step · Star! · Star! · Step. **Stretch:** make Robo **jump** instead of speaking on a star.

Step 4. Parsons puzzle (8 minutes)

Say: "Robo must reach the **GOAL** without walking into a wall. Put the jumbled blocks in order. **One block is a trick.**" Robo starts on row 1, column 1, facing right.

```
        col 1      col 2      col 3      col 4      col 5
row 1  [START >]  [       ]  [       ]  [       ]  [ WALL ]
row 2  [ WALL  ]  [ WALL  ]  [ WALL  ]  [       ]  [ WALL ]
row 3  [ WALL  ]  [ WALL  ]  [ WALL  ]  [ GOAL  ]  [ WALL ]
```

```
repeat 6 times
    if < wall ahead? > then
        turn right
    else
        move forward 1 square
    end
end

Trick block: turn left
```

Repeat	Where Robo is	Wall ahead?	Robo does
1	row 1, col 1, facing right	No	move forward → col 2
2	row 1, col 2	No	move forward → col 3
3	row 1, col 3	No	move forward → col 4
4	row 1, col 4	**Yes**	turn right → facing down
5	row 1, col 4, facing down	No	move forward → row 2
6	row 2, col 4, facing down	No	move forward → row 3 = **GOAL**

Step 5. Make (6 minutes) and exit ticket (2 minutes)

Say: "With your partner, draw your own row of 5 squares with two kinds of square. Write your rule: *If Robo is on a __ square, then _, else _._* Swap with the next pair; they predict, then you check together."

Exit ticket: (1) Row `[START] [puddle] [puddle] [plain]`, code card A with **repeat 3 times**: what does Robo say? *(Splash! · Splash! · Step)* (2) Circle the block that makes Robo choose. *(if-else)*

5.3 Observation sheet (interviewer)

Fill in while the teacher reads the lesson aloud or walks through it. Don't help unless the teacher is stuck for more than about 30 seconds.

School code		Date		Role		Start-end	

Step	Planned	Teacher's estimate	Questions or hesitations (quote)	Would change it?
1. Predict and run	8 min			-
2. Investigate	8 min			-
3. Modify	8 min			-
4. Parsons puzzle	8 min			-
5. Make	6 min			-
Exit ticket	2 min			-

After the walkthrough

1. Could you run this in one period tomorrow? What would stop you?

2. Which step would your students find hardest?

3. What would you change?

4. Would you use it on a projector, on paper, or in the computer lab?

5. Is the answer key enough, or would you need more help? What kind?

6. Which maths chapter could this sit inside? Is if-else too early for Class 4?

Teacher could run it without help -

Estimated total time -

5.4 Student sheet

Names: _____ **Class:** _____

1. Predict

```
   1          2          3          4          5
[ START ]  [ PUDDLE ]  [ plain ]  [ PUDDLE ]  [ plain ]
```

Robo will say: _____ , _____ , _____ , _____

2. Modify

```
[ START ]  [ plain ]  [ STAR ]  [ STAR ]  [ plain ]
```

What I changed inside the if-else: _____

Robo will say: _____ , _____ , _____ , _____

3. Parsons puzzle: help Robo reach the GOAL

```
        col 1      col 2      col 3      col 4      col 5
row 1  [START >]  [       ]  [       ]  [       ]  [ WALL ]
row 2  [ WALL  ]  [ WALL  ]  [ WALL  ]  [       ]  [ WALL ]
row 3  [ WALL  ]  [ WALL  ]  [ WALL  ]  [ GOAL  ]  [ WALL ]
```

Cut out these blocks and put them in order. One block is a trick! (cut along the dashed lines)

```
move forward 1 square
```

```
repeat 6 times
```

```
turn left
```

```
else
```

```
if < wall ahead? > then
```

```
turn right
```

```
end (of if)
```

```
end (of repeat)
```

4. Make your own

```
[       ] [       ] [       ] [       ] [       ]
```

Our rule: **If** Robo is on a _____ square, **then** _____, **else** _____.

6. Device audit

Fill with the computer teacher or IT staff, one sheet per school. Numbers, not impressions; write "don't know" rather than guessing. Ask to see the lab.

School code · date · filled with (role)	

1. Computer lab

Number of computer labs	
Computers in the main lab (total)	
...of which working today	
Operating system (Windows version / Linux / ChromeOS)	
Approximate age of most computers (years)	
Typical RAM (if known)	
Students in a typical section	
Students per working computer during a lab period	
Number of sections that share the lab	
Lab minutes per week for a Class 4 section	
Lab minutes per week for a Class 7 section	
Scratch / PictoBlox installed? Online or offline?	
Python installed?	

2. Tablets and other devices

School-owned tablets (number)	
...Android / iPad / other	
...of which working today	
Who can use them (which classes)?	
Do students bring phones or tablets for any classwork?	

3. Classrooms

Number of classrooms (Classes 3-8)	
...with a projector or smart board	
...of which working today	
...with a teacher laptop or PC connected	
Projector in the Class 3-5 rooms specifically?	

4. Internet and Class 8 AI labs

Internet in the lab: yes / no / unreliable	
Internet in classrooms: yes / no / unreliable	
Connection type (broadband / mobile hotspot / none)	
How often does it fail during a lesson?	
Websites blocked by a filter? scratch.mit.edu and teachablemachine.withgoogle.com allowed?	
Webcams available (number)	
Microphones or headsets available (number)	

5. Power and support

Power cuts during school hours (never / weekly / daily)	
Backup power for the lab (UPS / inverter / generator / none)	
Who fixes broken devices, and how long does it take?	

6. Funding and schemes

Lab funded by a government scheme (Samagra Shiksha ICT, Atal Tinkering Lab)?	
Does the school have an Atal Tinkering Lab? Is it in use?	
Any devices planned for next session?	

7. Interviewer's summary

Best description -

Notes

7. Same-day debrief

Fill in within a few hours of the visit, while memory is fresh. This feeds the hypothesis tracker in the Research Pack.

School code		Date		Role		Start-end	

People interviewed (roles)	
Board / fee tier / city type / medium	
Top 3 takeaways	
Strongest quote (role)	

#	Hypothesis	Evidence today	Why (quote or fact)
H1	Implementing CBSE CT&AI in 2026-27	Not discussed	
H2	Struggling to deliver with current teachers	Not discussed	
H3	Will pay alongside free books	Not discussed	
H4	A Rs 300-600 package is acceptable	Not discussed	
H5	Unplugged-first fits equipment	Not discussed	
H6	Maths teacher can run a level in one period	Not discussed	
H7	Assessment/reporting is a reason to buy	Not discussed	
H8	ICSE has a similar need	Not discussed	
H9	Want a Scratch-to-Python route	Not discussed	
H10	Struggle with what CBSE didn't provide	Not discussed	
H11	Would put a workbook + app on the booklist	Not discussed	
H12	Would replace the current Computers book	Not discussed	
H13	Student-data handling matters to buyers	Not discussed	

Surprises / things to add to the guides	

Done	Follow-up
☐	Thank-you message sent
☐	Tracking sheet updated (status, dates, device summary A-E)
☐	Audio deleted after notes were checked
☐	Pilot interest noted (if raised by the school)
☐	Hypothesis tracker updated (every 5 schools)